

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	REMOVAL OF EXISTING ROCK IN FAILED DRAIN	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training	To prevent injuries or illness to workers	1	1. Machinery operators will have the necessary current licence for the equipment they will operate. 2. All persons will have a current construction induction card eg White Card.	Management All	2
Machine Pre Start Check	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident.	1	1. Equipment Pre start checklist forms filled out & defects documented, Foreman notified.	Operators	2
General safety issues	Struck by road or construction plant.	1	1. Foreman will assess the hazards and risks on site eg trees & narrow roads, overhead wires, traffic etc. and will implement control measures – record hazards & controls on Site Specific Induction & Tool Box Meeting form and hold a toolbox meeting with all workers on site to discuss hazards and control measures. 2. Barricade area off or sign appropriately to restrict access and minimise plant working area. 3. All persons on site to wear safety vests. 4. Operational flashing lights and reversing beepers on all mobile plant.	Foreman All Operator	2
	Persons falling or tripping over on site.	2	1. Maintain good housekeeping. 2. Barricade off unsafe areas. 3. Clearly mark protruding objects using paint, caps or hazard tape.	All Foreman	3
	Dust entering eyes	2	1. Eye protection to be worn when required.	All	3
	Striking overhead services- electrocution Excavator or Wheeled loader	1	Operators need to keep; 1. At least 3 metres from 132,000 volt lines. 2. At least 6 metres from 132,000 to 330,000volt lines. 3. Areas closer than 3m are no go zone. 4. Use certified spotter if working near powerlines. 5. (3m to 6.4m). 6. Clarify safe working distances with site manager. 7. If in doubt of line voltage keep at least 8 metres away. If your machine makes contact with electrical wires- Refer to Emergency Procedures below and the A5 laminated card in the cabin.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			Overhead Wires – Emergency Procedure - Stay calm. - Do not leave your seat. - Warn others to stay away. - If possible, try to break contact with the wires, if possible try to lower the bucket without causing further damage to the power lines. - Make sure that the bucket does not make contact with the ground as this could earth the machine. - Phone emergency services to have power turned off. If it is unsafe to stay in/on the machine because the machine is in danger, such as from fire or if you are alone. Jump well clear onto dry ground if possible, making sure you have both legs together and shuffle or hop (eg ; kangaroo hop) and hop at least 10 metres away from the machine. - Do not climb down because if you make contact with the machine and the ground at the same time you could be electrocuted. - If the contact point is under the ground there is an area around that point which can be electrified. - Jump well clear of that point and move away from the machine and warn others to keep away. - Stay near the site until help arrives. - Report the incident to your Foreman immediately who may need to report to Workcover.		
	Exposure to noise	2	- Suppress noise using mufflers. - Ear protection must be worn by personnel working near noisy equipment.	Workshop All	3
Removal of existing rock & re-shaping of drain with 20T & 5T excavator with compaction plate	Striking other objects or people whilst slewing excavator, materials on the ground flicking up as excavator travels over site. Overbalance of machine at reach.	1	- Where possible minimise plant & personnel in work areas. - All persons are advised of dangers of working plant at the toolbox meeting. - Be aware of what obstacles or persons are around the site especially when slewing excavator. - Assess what weights the machine can handle at reach safely before attempting to load trucks.	Foreman Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			5. Do not carry passengers. 6. Keep machine under control at all times. 7. Carry the bucket as close to the ground as possible whilst traveling. 8. Travel & operate at a safe speed for the operation being undertaken.		
	Uncontrolled slippage	1	1. Assess ground surface conditions eg; wet ground conditions, steep slope. 2. When working on top of mound make sure excavator is not taken too close to the edge.	Operator	2
	Attachments or bucket disconnecting from quick hitch.	1	1. Ensure quick hitch safety pins are engaged whilst bucket or attachments are engaged into quick hitch.	Operator	2
	Striking personnel and plant	1	1. Hold toolbox meeting to discuss hazards. 2. Reflective safety vests to be worn at all times. 3. Separate trafficable areas. 4. Install giveaway and stop signs where necessary. 5. Excavator to have operational flashing light and reversing beeper.	Foreman All Foreman	2
	Ground failure leading to machine rollover and personnel being crushed	1	1. Only competent operators to use machinery. 2. Operator to complete visual assessment of ground conditions. 3. All unbattered excavations to be barricaded off. 4. Do not operate close to an overhang or a deep ditch or excavation the weight could collapse the sides of the trench. 5. Always approach embankments or trenches from a 90 degree angle. 6. Do not use the bucket as a hammer. 7. When working on a slope determine whether to dump the spoil on the high side or low side of the trench.	Foreman Operator Foreman Operator	2
Compaction of drain	Release of hydraulic hoses when changing work implements such as tilt bucket, pulverisor, rockbreaker and compaction plate.	2	1. Compactor plate will be used on the 5t excavator to compact the drain. 2. Ensure hydraulic pressure is taken off hydraulic hoses before releasing couplings. Pressure is normally released if engine is shut down and work tool pedal is pressed back & forth or two way flow ball valve is switched off.	Operator	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Compaction plate	2	1. Be aware that vibration can effect nearby buildings or unstable ground or trench walls & excavations. 2. Assess the situation & surrounding areas that may be affected.	Operator	3
120m of fabric with a Bentonite membrane will be rolled out using the excavator with a specific lifting device attached.	Striking personnel and plant.	2	1. Lifting device is to be attached to excavator as per manufactures instructions by trained persons. 2. All persons not involved in task to keep clear at all times.	Foreman Operator	3
Once fabric has been laid out in the drain a 400ml layer of small rock will be laid over fabric and then 400-500ml of larger rock laid down. Equipment 950G Wheeled loader 20T Excavator	Striking personnel and plant	1	1. Rock will be stockpiled on site by client. 2. Excavator will be used to load rock onto the wheeled loader and delivered to the area to be covered. 3. When the drain is near the stockpile the loader will be used to lay rock. 4. Only competently trained and licensed persons to operate loader and excavator. 5. Plant operators should be aware at all times of their surroundings and watch out for persons and other vehicles. 6. All persons on site are to stay well clear of plant when in operation.	Foreman Operators All	2
Maintenance	Personal injury	1	1. Move machine to a position away from the work site. 2. Remove keys from ignition. 3. Place a lock out danger tag on the steering wheel of the machine to alert others that you are working under or behind machine and not to start the machine.	Operator	2
Identifying additional daily hazards	Could be Various	1-3	1. Prior to the daily Toolbox Meeting the Supervisor and or workers will walk the work site and identify potential hazards. The management of these hazards will be discussed at the toolbox meeting and additional hazards & controls to those documented in this SWMS will be recorded on the Toolbox Meeting Minutes form.	Foreman	2-3

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Bitumen/Prime	During heavy rain, recently placed prime or bitumen could emulsify and wash into surrounding waterways.	1	1. Plan prime or bitumen operation so that it is conducted during fine weather. 2. Have material available to clean up a spill if it occurs and dispose of contaminated material accordingly. 3. Protect storm drains during and after application to prevent pollution - have spill clean-up materials available.	Supervisor All	2
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during “normal” hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste asphalt will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training	
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018		
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019		
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018		
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		Safe Design of Structures - 2018		
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.